THE MARINE ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION COMMITTEE, RECALLING Article 38(a) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Marine Environment Protection Committee (the Committee) conferred upon it by international conventions for the prevention and control of marine pollution from ships, RECALLING ALSO that, at its fifty-eighth session, the Committee adopted, by resolution MEPC.176(58), arevised MARPOL Annex VI which significantly strengthens the emission limits for sulphur oxides (SOX), RECALLING FURTHER that, at its fifty-ninth session, the Committee adopted, by resolution MEPC.184(59), the 2009 Guidelines for exhaust gas cleaning systems (hereinafter referred to as "2009 EGCS Guidelines"), NOTING that the revised MARPOL Annex VI entered into force on 1 July 2010, - resolution MEPC.184(59), the 2009 Guidelines for exhaust gas cleaning systems (hereinafter referred to as "2009 EGCS Guidelines"), NOTING that the revised MARPOL Annex VI entered into force on 1 July 2010, NOTING ALSO that regulation 4 of MARPOL Annex VI allows the use of an alternative compliance method at least as effective in terms of emission reductions as that required by MARPOL Annex VI, including any of the standards set forth in regulation 14, taking into account guidelines developed by the Organization, RECOGNIZING the need to update the 2009 EGCS Guidelines accordingly, HAVING CONSIDERED, at its sixty-eighth session, draft amendments to the 2009 EGCS Guidelines, prepared by the Sub-Committee on Pollution Prevention and Response, at its second session, 1 ADOPTS the 2015 Guidelines for exhaust gas cleaning systems , as set out in the annex to the present resolution; 2 INVITES Administrations to take these Guidelines into account when allowing the use of an exhaust gas cleaning system in accordance with regulation 4 of MARPOL Annex VI; 3 REQUESTS Parties to MARPOL Annex VI and other Member Governments to bring - use of an exhaust gas cleaning system in accordance with regulation 4 of MARPOL Annex VI; 3 REQUESTS Parties to MARPOL Annex VI and other Member Governments to bring these Guidelines to the attention of shipowners, ship operators, shipbuilders, marine diesel engine manufacturers and any other interested groups; 4 INVITES Administrations to provide for collection of data as described in appendix 3 of these Guidelines; 5 AGREES to keep these Guidelines under review in the light of experience gained with their application; 6 SUPERSEDES the 2009 EGCS Guidelines adopted by resolution MEPC.184(59). RESOLUTION MEPC.259(68) (adopted on 15 May 2015) 2015 GUIDELINES FOR EXHAUST GAS CLEANING SYSTEMSMEPC 68/21/Add.1 Annex 1, page 2 Documents/English/MEPC 68-21-ADD.1 (E).doc ANNEX 2015 GUIDELINES FOR EXHAUST GAS CLEANING SYSTEMS 1 INTRODUCTION 1.1 Regulation 14 of Annex VI requires ships to use fuel oil with asulphur content not exceeding that stipulated in regulations 14.1 or 14.4. Regulation 4 allows, with the approval of the Administration, the use of an alternative compliance method at least as effective in - exceeding that stipulated in regulations 14.1 or 14.4. Regulation 4 allows, with the approval of the Administration, the use of an alternative compliance method at least as effective in terms of emission reductions as that required by the Annex, including the standards set forth in regulation 14. The Administration of a Party should take into account any relevant guidelines developed by the Organization pertaining to alternatives provided for in regulation 4. 1.2 Similar to a NO Xemission reduction system, an exhaust gas cleaning (EGC) unit may be approved subject to periodic parameter and emission checks or the system may be equipped with acontinuous emission monitoring system. These guidelines have been developed with the intention of being objective and performance oriented. Furthermore, use of the SO 2(ppm)/CO2(%) ratio method will simplify the monitoring of SO Xemission and facilitate approval of an EGC unit. See appendix II